
INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 4A Literary representations

Thursday 12 June 2025 07:00 GMT Time allowed: 2 hours 30 minutes

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an OxfordAQA 12-page Answer Book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **all** questions. There is **one** question in Section A and **one** question in Section B.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Prose

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Read the following extract carefully. It is taken from *Nineteen Eighty-Four* by George Orwell, first published in 1949.

This is the opening of the novel, which is set in an imagined future. It describes the world of Oceania, a brutal dictatorship under the control of Big Brother. Winston Smith is one of its ordinary citizens.

Write an analysis of this extract, in which you focus on the significance of the representation of class and culture.

[25 marks]

It was a bright cold day in April, and the clocks were striking thirteen. Winston Smith, his chin nuzzled into his breast in an effort to escape the vile wind, slipped quickly through the glass doors of Victory Mansions, though not quickly enough to prevent a swirl of gritty dust from entering along with him.

The hallway smelt of boiled cabbage and old rag mats. At one end of it a coloured poster, too large for indoor display, had been tacked to the wall. It depicted simply an enormous face, more than a metre wide: the face of a man of about forty-five, with a heavy black moustache and ruggedly handsome features. Winston made for the stairs. It was no use trying the lift. Even at the best of times it was seldom working, and at present the electric current was cut off during daylight hours. It was part of the economy drive in preparation for Hate Week. The flat was seven flights up, and Winston, who was thirty-nine and had a varicose ulcer above his right ankle, went slowly, resting several times on the way. On each landing, opposite the lift-shaft, the poster with the enormous face gazed from the wall. It was one of those pictures which are so contrived that the eyes follow you about when you move. BIG BROTHER IS WATCHING YOU, the caption beneath it ran.

Inside the flat a fruity voice was reading out a list of figures which had something to do with the production of pig-iron. The voice came from an oblong metal plaque like a dulled mirror which formed part of the surface of the right-hand wall. Winston turned a switch and the voice sank somewhat, though the words were still distinguishable. The instrument (the telescreen, it was called) could be dimmed, but there was no way of shutting it off completely. He moved over to the window: a smallish, frail figure, the meagreness of his body merely emphasized by the blue overalls which were the uniform of the party. His hair was very fair, his face naturally sanguine, his skin roughened by coarse soap and blunt razor blades and the cold of the winter that had just ended.

Outside, even through the shut window-pane, the world looked cold. Down in the street little eddies of wind were whirling dust and torn paper into spirals, and though the sun was shining and the sky a harsh blue, there seemed to be no colour in anything, except the posters that were plastered everywhere. The black-moustachio'd face gazed down from every commanding corner. There was one on the house-front immediately opposite. BIG BROTHER IS WATCHING YOU, the caption said, while the dark eyes looked deep into Winston's own. Down at street level another poster, torn at one corner, flapped fitfully in the wind, alternately covering and uncovering the single word INGSOC. In the far distance a helicopter skimmed down between the roofs, hovered for an instant like a bluebottle, and darted away again with a curving flight. It was the police patrol, snooping into people's windows. The patrols did not matter, however. Only the Thought Police mattered.

Glossary

INGSOC: the political philosophy of Oceania, an apparent abbreviation of 'English Socialism'

pig-iron: an impure form of iron

rag mats: hard wearing rugs made out of rags

sanguine: of a flushed, reddish complexion

telescreen: a device that operates both as a television and a security camera

varicose ulcer: a swollen vein that causes a knot on the skin surface

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Poetry

0	2
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Read carefully the following poem, 'In Golden Gate Park That Day' by Lawrence Ferlinghetti, published in 1958. The poem is set in San Francisco, USA. It describes a couple's day out in the park.

Write an analysis of this poem, in which you focus on the significance of the representation of love between a man and a woman.

[25 marks]

In Golden Gate Park That Day . . .

In Golden Gate Park that day
 a man and his wife were coming along
 thru the enormous meadow
 which was the meadow of the world
 He was wearing green suspenders
 and carrying an old beat-up flute
 in one hand
 while his wife had a bunch of grapes
 which she kept handing out
 individually
 to various squirrels
 as if each
 were a little joke

And then the two of them came on
 thru the enormous meadow
 which was the meadow of the world
 and then
 at a very still spot where the trees dreamed
 and seemed to have been waiting thru all time
 for them
 they sat down together on the grass
 without looking at each other
 and ate oranges
 without looking at each other
 and put the peels
 in a basket which they seemed
 to have brought for that purpose
 without looking at each other

And then
 he took his shirt and undershirt off
 but kept his hat on
 sideways
 and without saying anything
 fell asleep under it
 And his wife just sat there looking
at the birds which flew about
 calling to each other
 in the stilly air
 as if they were questioning existence
 or trying to recall something forgotten

But then finally
 she too lay down flat
 and just lay there looking up
 at nothing
 yet fingering the old flute
 which nobody played
 and finally looking over
 at him
 without any particular expression
 except a certain awful look
 of terrible depression

Lawrence Ferlinghetti

Glossary

thru: through

suspenders: braces for holding up trousers

undershirt: a vest

END OF QUESTIONS

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